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China Auto Manufacturers

Weekly EV Orders (Except NIO) continually missed (11-17 May)

CITI'S TAKE

Weekly Orders continually missed: According to weekly orders, we estimate last week (11-17 May) China NEV orders improved by 4% WoW with first 17-days daily average surging 7.9% MoM which is not strong enough to improve Beta trend because: (1) If May full month NEV retail also up 8% MoM, the implied YoY would still be negative at -8% YoY; (2) Inventory concerns ([End-Apr Inventories estimate](#)); (3) High variances between brands for WoW and MoM comparison enlarged to 56ppt and 87ppt, implying divergent growth trend among brands. **BYD downside risk remains:** Combining only Ocean and Dynasty brands, BYD's WoW (-7%) and MoM (-19%) trend both underperformed sector. While export growth may help to defend its 2Q earnings yet to be released by end-Aug, the May-July domestic growth momentum remains relatively un-exciting.

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Xpeng/Tesla: Both registered daily average MoM at negative pace (-43%/-12%).

Nio/Li: Nio appears to be significantly outperforming at 48% MoM (113% WoW) with new product cycle; while Li's MoM at 6% after including new L9 orders provide limited visibility 2Q margin trend at this stage.

The only minor positive (April Orders-to-Sales; Figure 3): We estimate Apr26 NEV sector's orders-to-sales ratio was 1.59x (10% YoY, 6% MoM) with BYD ratio up 9% YoY. However as sector also entered into down-cycle from May-2025, a slightly better order-to-sales ratio on YoY comparison this year could be irrelevant.

Further readings:

[NIO \(NIO.N\) – A ST Game Changer; 2Q margin visibility > BYD/Li/Xpeng/Leapmotor, Buy](#)

[Li Auto \(LI.O\) – Not A Game Changer; Maintain Neutral](#)

[Leapmotor \(9863.HK\) – Expect 2Q Breakeven, Lower FY26 GPM to 14.5%, Buy](#)

[BYD \(1211.HK\) – BYD Export MSRP & Discount Tracker \(End-April\)](#)

[BYD \(1211.HK\) – BYD inventory Update; Estimating Sales Volume Required to Deliver Positive YoY Growth in June](#)

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

Figure 1. Weekly Order

Brands	Apr-26				May-26		
	1st week 30 Mar - 5 Apr	2nd week 6 Apr - 12 Apr	3rd week 13 Apr - 19 Apr	4th week 20 Apr - 26 Apr	1st week 27 Apr - 3 May	2nd week 4 May - 10 May	3rd week 11 May - 17 May
Li Auto	8.4k	9.3k	8.8k	8.2k	7.4k	6.3k	13.4k
Huawei Harmony	11.5k	11.2k	9.6k	64.3k	50.8k	28.4k	31.5k
Leapmotor				17.8k	18.8k	17.7k	12.7k
NIO (incl. ONVO)	10.4k	9.9k	9.6k	11.5k	9.9k	10.0k	21.3k
BYD	63.1k	53.0k	49.1k	47.5k	51.2k	43.7k	40.7k
Zeekr				19.2k	12.3k	9.0k	7.1k
Tesla	15.1k	15.8k	13.4k	13.3k	15.1k	13.7k	11.4k
Geely Galaxy				17.3k	16.7k	13.9k	13.4k
Xpeng (incl. Mona)	16.5k	9.1k	7.8k	6.8k	6.8k	6.3k	5.4k

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Figure 2. Weekly Order

	11-17 May single week WoW	Implied May 17-days daily avg. MoM
BYD (Ocean + Dynasty)	-7%	-19%
Huawei Harmony	11%	215%
Li Auto	113%	6%
Tesla	-17%	-12%
Nio	113%	48%
Xpeng	-14%	-43%
Zeekr	-21%	NA
Leapmotor	-28%	NA
Geely Galaxy	-4%	NA
EV Sector	4%	7.9%

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Figure 3. Order-to-sales Summary

	Orders to Sales					
	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	Apr26 vs. Mar26	Apr26 vs. Apr25
BYD (Dynasty & Ocean)	2.60	1.39	1.59	1.47	-8%	9%
Tesla	1.98	0.86	1.11	2.36	113%	66%
Li Auto	0.86	0.56	0.67	1.09	64%	-7%
Huawei Harmony	0.73	0.72	1.75	3.71	113%	-6%
Leapmotor	1.59	-	-	-	na	na
Zeekr	0.88	-	-	-	na	na
NIO (incl. Onvo)	0.71	0.64	1.11	1.32	19%	6%
Xpeng (incl. Mona)	2.06	1.15	1.92	1.56	-19%	42%
Geely Galaxy	1.96	-	-	-	na	na
Xiaomi	0.36	0.50	2.71	0.92	-66%	-30%
Subtotal	1.44	1.01	1.50	1.59	6%	10%

	Orders				Retail Sales			
	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26
BYD (Dynasty & Ocean)	200.4k	96.5k	252.2k	223.9k	77.2k	69.5k	158.4k	152.8k
Tesla	39.7k	32.6k	60.9k	61.9k	20.0k	37.9k	54.9k	26.2k
Li Auto	23.8k	14.6k	26.9k	36.4k	27.6k	26.0k	40.4k	33.4k
Huawei Harmony	40.4k	19.6k	45.6k	122.3k	55.6k	27.0k	26.1k	33.0k
Leapmotor	34.2k	na	na	na	21.5k	16.6k	37.6k	49.8k
Zeekr	16.8k	na	na	na	19.0k	14.7k	23.6k	23.1k
NIO (incl. Onvo)	21.1k	13.4k	38.2k	44.0k	29.9k	20.9k	34.5k	33.4k
Xpeng (incl. Mona)	32.7k	14.6k	41.6k	39.4k	15.9k	12.7k	21.7k	25.3k
Geely Galaxy	70.1k	na	na	na	35.8k	28.7k	61.8k	64.8k
Xiaomi	14.0k	10.2k	60.6k	33.5k	39.0k	20.3k	22.3k	36.6k
Subtotal (units)	493.1k	276.9k	721.6k	762.8k	341.6k	274.3k	481.3k	478.3k

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Companies Mentioned:

BYD (1211.HK; HK\$93.8; 1; 18 May 26; 16:10)
BYD (002594.SZ; Rmb94.51; 1; 18 May 26; 15:00)
Geely Automobile (0175.HK; HK\$20.58; 1; 18 May 26; 16:10)
Leapmotor (9863.HK; HK\$41.68; 1; 18 May 26; 16:10)
Li Auto (LI.O; US\$16.69; 2; 18 May 26; 16:00)
Li Auto Inc (2015.HK; HK\$64.9; 2; 18 May 26; 16:10)
NIO (NIO.N; US\$5.88; 1; 18 May 26; 16:00)
NIO (9866.HK; HK\$47.54; 1; 18 May 26; 16:10)
Xiaomi (1810.HK; HK\$30.66; 1; 18 May 26; 16:10)
XPeng (XPEV.N; US\$15.06; 1; 18 May 26; 16:00)
XPeng (9868.HK; HK\$60.65; 1; 18 May 26; 16:10)

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